

School of Economic, Political and Policy Sciences

Public Health (BA)

The field of public health involves the study and promotion of the health of communities and populations. Public health practitioners monitor and seek to control the spread of infectious diseases, behavioral risks, and environmental hazards that affect health, as well as to promote healthier behavior. The Bachelor of Arts in Public Health (BAPH) program provides understanding into the social structural and cultural factors that shape health and illness at the individual and population levels; and knowledge about effective strategies for promoting the health of individuals and communities. The curriculum includes basic training in social epidemiology, statistics, research methods, and program development and evaluation.

The BAPH program prepares students for a variety of roles in the health care system, in community-based private and nonprofit groups, in public agencies such as local and state health departments and the U.S. Public Health Service and Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, and in global health programs. These might include entry level epidemiology or community health education roles from county to federal level. Students will be prepared for graduate training in a Master of Public Health (MPH/MSPH) program and can choose to sit for the Certified Health Education Specialist (CHES) certification upon graduation. The BAPH is also a good fit for those seeking clinical careers in medicine, nursing, medical social work, and mental health who seek a better understanding of the social and community dimensions of health and illness.

Bachelor of Arts in Public Health

[Degree Requirements](#) (120 semester credit hours)¹

[View an Example of Degree Requirements by Semester](#)

Faculty

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I. Core Curriculum Requirements: 42 semester credit hours²

Communication: 6 semester credit hours

Choose two courses from the following:

[COMM 1311](#) Survey of Oral and Technology-based Communication

[RHET 1302](#) Rhetoric

Or select any 6 semester credit hours from [Communication Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Mathematics: 3 semester credit hours

[MATH 1314](#) College Algebra

Or select any 3 semester credit hours from [Mathematics Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Life and Physical Sciences: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [Life and Physical Sciences Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Language, Philosophy and Culture: 3 semester credit hours

Select any 3 semester credit hours from [Language, Philosophy and Culture Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Creative Arts: 3 semester credit hours

Select any 3 semester credit hours from [Creative Arts Core](#) courses (see advisor)

American History: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 3 semester credit hours from [American History Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Government/Political Science: 6 semester credit hours

[GOVT 2305](#) American National Government

[GOVT 2306](#) State and Local Government

Or select any 6 semester credit hours from [Government/Political Science Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Social and Behavioral Sciences: 3 semester credit hours

[SOC 1301](#) Introduction to Sociology^{3, 4}_{— —}

Or select any 3 semester credit hours from [Social and Behavioral Sciences Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Component Area Option: 6 semester credit hours

[EPPS 2301](#) Research Design in the Social and Policy Sciences^{3, 4, 5}_{— — —}

[EPPS 2302](#) Methods of Quantitative Analysis in the Social and Policy Sciences^{3, 4, 5}_{— — —}

Or select any 6 semester credit hours from [Component Area Option Core](#) courses (see advisor)

II. Major Requirements: 48 semester credit hours

Major Preparatory Courses: 3 semester credit hours beyond Core Curriculum

[ECON 2301](#) Principles of Macroeconomics

or [ECON 2302](#) Principles of Microeconomics

[EPPS 2301](#) Research Design in the Social and Policy Sciences^{3, 6, 5}_{— — —}

[EPPS 2302](#) Methods of Quantitative Analysis in the Social and Policy Sciences^{3, 4, 5}_{— — —}

[SOC 1301](#) Introduction to Sociology^{3, 4}_{— —}

Major Core Courses: 27 semester credit hours

[SOC 3303](#) Classical Social Theory

[SOC 4305](#) Applied Data Analysis

[SOC 3381](#) Field Research Methods

or [PA 3381](#) Field Research Methods

[SOC 4306](#) Advanced Sociological Research

[SOC 4369](#) Public Health and Society

[SOC 4372](#) Health and Illness

[SOC 4384](#) Social Epidemiology

[SOC 4385](#) Global Health and Society

[SOC 4386](#) Health and Social Policy

or [PA 4386](#) Health and Social Policy

or [PSCI 3325](#) American Public Policy

Major Related Courses: 18 semester credit hours

Choose 18 semester credit hours from the following:

[ECON 3330](#) Economics of Health

[GEOG 3357](#) Spatial Dimensions of Health and Disease

[GEOG 3372](#) Population and Development

[GEOG 3384](#) Sustainable Food and Place

[HLTH 1322](#) Human Nutrition

[PHIL 3320](#) Medical Ethics

[PSY 4346](#) Human Sexuality

[SOC 3315](#) Socio-Behavioral Sciences for Medicine

[SOC 3382](#) Sustainable Communities

[SOC 4302](#) Class, Status, and Power

[SOC 4357](#) Drugs, Alcohol and Society

[SOC 4371](#) Mental Health and Illness

[SOC 4V98](#) Internship

[SOC 3390](#) Community Health

[SOC 3391](#) Environmental Health

III. Elective Requirements: 30 semester credit hours

This requirement may be satisfied with lower- and upper-division courses from any field of study.

The plan must include sufficient upper-division courses to total 45 upper-division semester credit hours.

1. Incoming freshmen must enroll and complete requirements of UNIV 1010 and the corresponding school-related freshman seminar course. Students, including transfer students, who complete their core curriculum at UT Dallas must take UNIV 2020.
2. Curriculum Requirements can be fulfilled by other approved courses from institutions of higher education. The courses listed are recommended as the most efficient way to satisfy both Core Curriculum and Major Requirements at UT Dallas.
3. A Major requirement that also fulfills a Core Curriculum requirement. Semester credit hours are counted in Core Curriculum.
4. Prerequisite course to upper-division PA courses.

5. The Bachelor of Arts in Public Health degree requires EPPS 2301 and 2302 as a requirement or as a prerequisite for another required course which makes it a necessity to take both courses as soon as is prudent in a student's academic career. Otherwise students run the risk of falling behind in their time to graduation.

6. Prerequisite course to upper-division PH courses.

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